



ISTQB FOUNDATION MASTERCLASS

Exam Day Checklist

Everything to do before, during and after your ISTQB Foundation exam — plus the key logistics.

Introduction

The ISTQB Foundation exam rewards calm, methodical candidates. This checklist covers the logistics and a simple before, during and after routine so nothing catches you out on the day.

Exam Logistics at a Glance

Item	Detail
Number of questions	40 multiple-choice questions
Time allowed	60 minutes (75 minutes if sitting in a non-native language, where permitted)
Pass mark	65% — that is 26 out of 40 marks
Marks per question	1 mark each; no negative marking
Format	Multiple choice; usually one correct answer unless stated otherwise

TIP

There is no negative marking, so never leave a question blank. An educated guess can only help your score.

The Week Before

- Confirm the date, time and format (online-proctored or test centre).
- Check the ID you must bring — usually photo ID matching your booking name exactly.
- For online exams, run the system/equipment check the provider supplies.
- Do at least one full timed mock exam under real conditions.
- Review your weakest topics using your revision tracker, not everything at once.
- Prepare your test space (online) or plan your journey (test centre) in advance.

Before the Exam (on the day)

- Eat something and stay hydrated; avoid last-minute cramming that raises anxiety.
- Have your photo ID ready and to hand.
- For online exams: close all other applications, clear your desk, and check webcam, microphone and internet.
- For test centres: arrive early, leaving time for check-in and security.
- Read any exam instructions and rules before the timer starts.
- Take a slow breath and remind yourself you only need 26 out of 40.

During the Exam

1. Budget your time: 40 questions in 60 minutes is about 90 seconds each.
2. Read every question and all options fully before answering — watch for "NOT", "EXCEPT" and "BEST".
3. Answer the easy questions first to bank marks and build confidence.
4. Flag anything uncertain and move on; do not let one question eat your time.
5. Use elimination — rule out clearly wrong options to improve your odds.
6. Never leave a blank; make your best choice on flagged questions before time runs out.
7. Keep an eye on the clock and leave a few minutes to review flagged questions.

COMMON MISTAKE

Misreading negative or superlative wording ("which is NOT a test level", "which is the BEST technique") loses marks that candidates actually knew. Underline or mentally flag these words before choosing.

After the Exam

- Note your provisional result if shown immediately, and any next steps.
- If you passed, save your certificate and add the credential to your CV and LinkedIn.
- If you did not pass this time, review the topic breakdown and plan a focused retake.
- Jot down which question styles surprised you — useful feedback for others and for a retake.

INSIDE STLC PRO TIP

Do a first pass answering only the questions you are confident about, flagging the rest. This banks easy marks early and leaves the harder questions for a calmer second pass — a reliable way to reach the 26-mark threshold.

BEST PRACTICE

Simulate the real thing at least once: 40 questions, 60 minutes, no notes, no interruptions. Candidates who have rehearsed under time pressure make far fewer avoidable errors on the day.